involvement in Pakistan's economy (Siddiqa 2007), another common fault line through which Pakistan's troubles are explained is the opposition between the army and the rest of the population. Many scholars (Talbot 1998 and Lieven 2011 among others) have looked at the army's role in denying Pakistan a sustained democratic development; they argue that even in times of democratic rule, the army continued to rule the country from the 'back seat'. According to Rais (2017) the Pakistan military 'adopted three strategies to build the Pakistani state … de-politicization, centralization, and modernization of the economy' (p. 65). In particular, in order to achieve 'de-politicization' the military 'produced a politics of their own brand with the character of patronage, cultivation of groups that would serve as its "democratic" or political façade, and restructuring of political and state institutions to ensure its domination of the state' (p. 65). Today Pakistan again has a civilian government but the army remains a major stakeholder in politics.

In their article 'The Democracy Barometers, Surveying South Asia', De Souza et al. (2008) argue that those in Pakistan supporting democracy as a form of government (identified here as 'strong democrats') are down to 10 per cent of the population and 48 per cent are defined as 'weak democrats' (p. 90). Forty-one per cent of the population self-define as non-democrats, and the support-for-democracy ratio is 0.24 (p. 91). As such Pakistan is different from all the other South Asian countries where democrats outnumber non-democrats in much higher numbers (p. 89). De Souza et al. also contend that those who are more educated tend to support democracy more than those who are less educated (p. 92) and that having experienced democracy also had a positive correlation with being supportive of democracy. As a result of Pakistan's many years under military rule, today's youth has had less exposure to democracy than young people in other South Asian countries, and according to De Souza this matters when it comes to how they describe their political leanings.

Kugelman (2012) sees the role that patronage plays, reiterating Lyon's (2002) and Lieven's (2011) ideas that many would hesitate to change the political order in ways that could threaten the structure they depend on for future influence. Although young people did not mention this explicitly, their families would caution about too radical a change. In fact, one can argue that Nawaz Sharif's win in the May 2013 elections underlined this point. Many wanted change but were equally reluctant to give it to the PTI, who they saw as inexperienced in 2013. Neither does Kugelman (2012) believe that anger and alienation could translate into a youth-led, religion-based political movement, despite many young people being in general anti-government and anti-American, with a majority favouring an Islamic style of governance.